2026

English Communication I

First Semester Term-End

Examination (60mins.)

For 1st-Year students

August 27, 2026

First Semester Term-End English Communication I Examination for First-Year Students (60 minutes)

※ Write your answers to the questions on the ANSWER SHEET

This examination contains Three Sections: Listening Section (I ～ III), Vocabulary Section (IV ～ VI) and Comprehension Section (VII～X).

〈Listening Section〉

Listening Section consists of three Questions: Question 1, Question 2 and Question 3. For Question 1 and Question 2, the recording will be played ONCE, and for Question 3, the recording will be played TWICE. (2×10)

. Question 1

You are planning on studying abroad for a short term, and thinking about which city to choose. Listen to an explanation on The Student City Rankings in 2020 and 2026, and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank space (1) to (3) in the chart form the list below. Write the matching numbers, not the words, on the ANSWER SHEET. The recording will be played ONCE, in about 30 seconds.

The Student City Rankings in 2020 and 2026

Rank		City (Country)
2026	2020	
1st	10th	(1)
2nd	2nd	(2)
3rd	1st	London (U.K.)
4th	4th	Munich (Germany)
5th	3rd	(3)

1. Boston (U.S.) 2. Melbourne (Australia) 3. New York (U.S.) 4. Seoul (South Korea) 5. Tokyo (Japan)

II. Question 2

Listen to a passage and answer the three questions below. Write the matching numbers, not the words, on the ANSWER SHEET. The recording will be played ONCE, in about 30 seconds.

1) What is the total area of Machu Picchu?

1. 13 square kilometers. 2. 30 square kilometers. 3) 200 square kilometers. 2,280 square kilometers.

2) Which of the following sentences is true about Machu Picchu?

1. It had a rich culture.
It was built by the Spanish.
It was built in the 16th century.
4) It was destroyed by the Incas.

Which of the following sentences is NOT true about Machu Picchu?

1. It is very popular with tourists.
2. It was discovered by Hiram Bingham.
3.) People lived there for about 400 years.
4. There are lots of mysteries about it.

Ⅲ. Question 3

Listen to a speech and answer the four following questions. Write the matching numbers, not the words, on the ANSWER SHEET. The recording will be played in thirty seconds, and in another thirty seconds, it'll be played again.

1) Which of the following sentences is true about the speaker's family?

1. The speaker likes her family's lifestyle because it's always stable.
2. The speaker's parents love their way of life that's full of ups and downs.
3. To the speaker, her parents' life lacks excitementt, so she has complaints.

2) Which of the following sentences is true about the speaker's father?

1. He shows to his children a guiding principle in his life both in words and actions.
2. He spends his spare time and money on activities with his family, rather than self-improvement.
3. He went to Japan when an earthquake struck it, in order to provide the victims with donations and supplies.

3) Which of the following sentences is true about the speaker's mother?

1. She is literally a coward when it comes to having an argument with her children.
2. She takes it for granted that children should obey their parents.
3. She told the speaker on one occasion that her father did something remarkable.

4) How was the speaker's reaction when her mother told her about what his father did in a disaster-stricken area?

1. As usual, she felt jealous of people who had ordinary parents.
2. Her mother's story about what her father did there shook the speaker's emotions.
3. She was so shocked about the chaotic situation there that she almost lost her consciousness.

〈Vocabulary Section〉

Ⅳ. For each of the following dialogues, select the most appropriate option from the list below to fill in numbered blank spaces (1) and (2). Write the matching letter, not the word, on the ANSWER SHEET. (1×8)

A : I'd been working under a lot of physical and mental strain, and at last, overwork made me ill last month. I wonder how long it'll take for my (1) to be paid.

B : Documents proving your illness are required. First of all, you'll need your doctor's note: signed paper from your physician describing your illness (2).

a) compound b) conservatively c) insurance d) objectively e) reform f) subjectively

2) A : The latest opinion (1) highlight how the government has lost the trust of its citizens lately.

B : I know what you mean. In my opinion, the Prime Minister's vision for this country's future is becoming (2), including a remedy for constantly rising prices.

a) accidental b) content c) means d) polls e) quotes f) vague

3) A : It's a real ( ) that your colleagues' casual remarks seemed to have offended your guests from abroad.

B : That's right. They meant no harm, but might have gotten a little too familiar. Anyway, I should have noticed an ( ) atmosphere between our guests and my colleagues much earlier.

a) awkward b) clue c) energetic d) innocent e) makeup f) shame

) A : I wonder why the (1) still stick to nuclear power, even after the Great East Japan Earthquake occurred only about a decade and a half ago.

B : After all, nuclear power boasts high reliability, including low environmental harm, steady power supply and high fuel efficiency, which the (2), such as wind and solar power, don't.

a) alternatives b) authorities c) fragments d) fundamentals e) humanities f) molecules

V. Each dialogue below is followed by a **summary**. For the dialogues, select the most appropriate option from the list below to fill in each of the numbered blank spaces (1) to (4) and write the matching letter, not the word(s). For each **summary**, write appropriate words starting with two to four designated letters to fill in numbered blank spaces (5) and (6). Write your answers on the ANSWER SHEET. (1×12)

1) **Katie** : I really appreciate the generous (1) offered by the fund you'd ( ), Mr. Ray. That's enabled me to complete my college education and land a rewarding job.

Mr. Ray : Congratulations on getting good (3), Katie, and thank you for your (4). I'm so proud of you.

a) compliment b) destination c) employment d) founded e) imaginary f) scholarship

〈Summary〉 Katie is grateful to **Mr. Ray** for his financial 5) (ai), telling him that she 6) (ow) him a lot, and in return, **Mr. Ray** admires **Katie's** achievement.

2) **Ken** : You're a math genius, Kim. You can always solve math problems quickly and precisely. I'm sure you're the best math student in school. You'll get admitted to a prestigious tech college.

Kim : Come on, Ken. You ( ) me. Actually, my parents try (2) me to go to college, but that's just (3) for me. Instead, I'll go to Africa and live with wild animals, just as Dr. Jane Goodall did. Studying animals at college is no (4) for living with wildlife.

a) adapted b) embarrassing c) overestimate d) substitute e) to persuade f) to submit

〈Summary〉 **Ken** believes that no one in his school can 5) (matc) **Kim** in math, while **Kim** dismisses his estimate of her and tells him that she can't 6) (resi) the desire to live with wildlife.

VI. Read each of the dialogues and passages, and select the most appropriate option from the list below to fill in numbered blank spaces (1) to (3). Write the matching letter, not the word, on the ANSWER SHEET. Please note that all words are written in lower case, even when they should go at the beginning of a sentence. (1×12)

1) A : The University of Tokyo is (1) the world's top universities.

B : I have doubts about this. That university is ranked 26th in the world, even though it's 1st in Japan.

A : That ranking (2) too much on the number of foreign professors and international students. It not always reflects the true academic quality of education properly. Anyway, what matters most is not the name of a university but what you want to study and which university will meet your expectations. So, you need to know each university's (3) of academic knowledge, faculty achievements and research capacity of your target field.

a) accumulation b) among c) as d) decorates e) found f) weighs

2) A : Where has Jim gone? We need him to discuss our volunteer cleanup project. Have you seen him at school?

B : Yeah. I saw him just now painting a big picture on a wood panel down on the schoolyard with some girls. He ( ) to be giving suggestions, so he must have been helping them with their art assignment or something.

A : Do you mean that he was ( ) on something to paint with other people? Don't kid me. He can't be interested in painting, and first of all, our project should be prioritized. I can't figure out why he is ( ) so cooperative with those girls, not us.

B : That's too obvious. He's trying to get with one of the girls!

a) being b) collaborating c) donated d) naïve e) quest f) seemed

3) Waste management may seem to be an effective way to stop (1) the oceans with plastic waste, but that's not always the case, because it requires huge costs. Some major industry cost analysts, for example, estimate that the U.S. commercial waste collection cost (2) accounts for more than $50 billion each year. Developing countries can't afford such enormous (3) of money.

a) alone b) amounts c) coastal d) polluting e) remove f) solutions

4) U.S. politics can't do ( ) huge financial donations from Israeli lobbyists, so it can't ignore Israel. (2), Israel has a great influence on U.S policy-making. To be sure, Donald Trump ought to put an end to war as soon as possible but he can't, because Israel doesn't want him stopping attacks until Iranian threat is gotten rid of completely. Moreover, Israel doesn't want the war to stop even temporarily, because it fears that ( ), Iran will restore its damaged missile sites and destroyed nuclear research facilities.

a) fortunately b) ideally c) in other words d) in the meantime e) nowhere f) without

〈Comprehension Section〉

Ⅶ. Each of the passages and dialogues below is followed by three sentences: a), b) and c). Out of these sentences, select the one that is true according to the passage or dialogue above. Write your answers on the ANSWERR SHEET. (2×4)

) In terms of the ocean cleanup, reducing the consumption of plastic is practically impossible, because for people living in the world today, plastic has become too common, while waste management systems are too costly for every country all around the world to adopt. These facts, however, don't mean that there is no effective method for cleaning up the oceans. One of the promising approaches is that of the NPO that Boyan Slat founded: focusing on the cleanup of the rivers causing more than 80 percent of the global plastic waste flowing into the oceans.

a) By concentrating our effort and energy on river cleanup, we can contribute to solving environmental problems.

b) The most effective way possible to clean up the oceans is to decrease the production and use of plastic items.

c) Waste management is so effective that every country around the world should try to focus on it, at any cost.

) Ocean pollution is significant harm for humanity. It damages their surrounding environment, weakens the economy and endangers the health of people. Plastic waste is one of the most harmful substances that humans have ever created. Every plastic user needs to bear this fact in mind.

a) Due to ocean pollution, the environment as well as human activities is harmfully affected, but healthy people are reluctant to admit.

b) This passage classifies the harm of ocean pollution into three clearly distinguished groups to alarm readers.

c) Whether plastic will act harmfully or not in a country depends on its steady effort to convince its citizens of the harm of plastic.

3) **Jessica**: Social injustice occurs when individuals or groups are treated unfairly or denied their basic human rights by systemic societal practices. Gender pay gap in employment and inequality in education are some of the common examples.

Tomoko: I know. In Japan, there have been structural barriers which prevent women's social progress. Roughly 90% of corporate managers are made up of males, and about 85% of the Diet seats are occupied by men. To my great surprise, I've hardly ever seen Japanese women who seem to recognize this situation as a social injustice.

a) According to **Jessica**'s explanation, if you fail a job exam, you can always call it social injustice.

b) **Jessica** and **Tomoko** both refuse to accept the physical or biological difference between men and women.

c) **Tomoko** can't understand why most Japanese women don't complain about gender inequality in business or politics.

4) **Ms. Sato**: Miyazaki Kensuke decided to leave the disaster-stricken area of the Great East Japan Earthquake for Mariupol, Ukraine in 2017. Ever since the 2014 Russian annexation of the Crimean Peninsula, the area had been in conflict. Despite his knowledge of this fact, he dared to conduct his painting project up there.

Hiroyuki: I wonder why he chose such a dangerous place. I doubt if his project was worth risking his life for.

a) **Hiroyuki** disagrees with the idea of an artist endangering his or her own life for their artistic sake.

b) Miyazaki Kensuke was naïve enough to be ignorant of the danger of going to Mariupol in 2017.

c) **Ms. Sato** expresses her detailed opinion and judgement on what Miyazaki Kensuke achieved, as well as delivering his story objectively.

Ⅷ. In order to respond to each question about the passages below reasonably, fill in **numbered blank spaces 1) ( ) to 3) ( )** with appropriate words starting with **two to four designated letters**. Write your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**. (1×12)

1) In London, I came across a TV program about a special school for orphans in Nairobi, Kenya. The children looked deeply unhappy. I suddenly had an overwhelming desire to go to Kenya and paint something for these children.

What brought the author to Kenya? — He 1) (hap) to watch a TV program featuring a school for children in Kenya 2) (wh) parents were d, and it stirred up his 3) (ur e) to go there and cheer those children up by painting for them.

2) The huge picture that Miyazaki Kensuke painted in an unsafe, conflict area appears to be the symbol of the power of art to get people together in two respects. First, the picture was created in collaboration of people who shared suffering. Second, the message delivered through its heartwarming big mitten and Easter-eggs 1) (rep) hope, can attract huge numbers of viewers from all around the world.

What is characteristic of the huge picture painted by Miyazaki Kensuke in a life-threatening region? — It's in that the picture successfully shows the power of art to 2) (brin) people together both physically and emotionally. The former relates to the collaboration in the process of its creation, while the latter has to do with the human 3) (warm) and encouragement expressed in it, which deserves to attract viewers.

3) Technology has made it possible for manufacturers to produce plastic items on a massive scale. Unfortunately, however, it has not dealt well with a mass of plastic waste, because plastic waste management has always 1) (cos) more than it has been profitable. Indeed, only less than 10% of global plastic waste is recycled. Even so, a rising environmental awareness will boost the sales of waste management systems, and lead plastic waste recycling business to be profitable.

According to the passage, what's the future of plastic waste management like? — Its future is bright, because raised environmental concerns will create 2) (deman　) for waste management systems even if they're costly. The more the products sell, the easier the business becomes. This economic mechanism will make the process of waste 3) (disp　) and recycling smoother.

4) Australia has lately become the first country to 1) (bar　) children under 16 from accessing major social media platforms, including Instagram, Facebook, X and YouTube. This law is aimed to protect children from the harm of social media, both physically and mentally. Interestingly, children or parents are not punished under the law. Instead, the responsibility is imposed on platform providers. It's a kind of turn-off-the-tap method.

In the context of this passage, what does the term "turn-off-the-tap method" mean? — It refers to a way to solve a serious problem of social media 2) (threa　) children's health and growth, by removing its upstream 3) (cau　) : platform providers.

IX. In the dialogues below, underlined parts [　　] contain five terms, but one of them is not required to complete the sentence. Rearrange the four remaining terms in the correct order, and write the numbers of the terms that go in the FIRST and THIRD places on the ANSWER SHEET. (3×3)

1) A : After you'd been teaching for more than a decade, you eventually made your mind to quit the job. Why?
B : I'd always been wondering [1. benefit / 2. I was really / 3. if / 4. in good / 5. of great] for the students' growth, and unfortunately, I didn't feel sure after all. Honestly, I didn't have confidence in my ability and achievement.

2) A : Do you know the meaning of the term "single use"? I came across this phrase in an article featuring countries which had been discharging tons of plastic waste into the oceans every single day.
B : A "single use" is an expression describing the general use of [1. are designed to be / 2. consumed exactly only once / 3. hatched peacefully / 4. products / 5. that] and then disposed of.

3) A : We were so excited to beat our rival on the tournament last Saturday that on our way home, we got distracted chatting on a station platform, and one of us found ourselves standing near the edge. Just shortly afterwards, when a train passed [1. and upset / 2. by, / 3. really frightened / 4. very surprising / 5. we were].
B : That's what happens when you get carried away. Good events are often accompanied by trouble.

X. Read the passage below and answer the following questions. (19)

1 I attend the Graduate School of the University of Tsukuba in Japan. My major is computer science, specifically applied AI technology. I'm from Ukraine, but let me conceal my real name. Call me Spokiy for now.

2 I came to Japan in January, 2022, right before the Russian invasion, and was admitted to the university under the international student quota. To me, Japan is the world's premier tech utopia. Its technological capabilities are really amazing. 1) They've enabled it to recover form a wide variety of hardships and disasters, ranging from its defeat of the Second World War to the Great East Japan Earthquake

3 My country has been fighting against Russia for four and a half years, and lately, it's eventually launched a counteroffensive by attacking major Russian infrastructures like oil refining facilities, far away from Ukrainian held territory. As everyone correctly points out, it's by using drones with cutting-edge AI technology installed that these achievements have been accomplished. In recent months, Ukraine has painfully demonstrated that AI technology determines the fate of military conflicts, and that's not limited to Ukraine.

4 In January this year, the Venezuelan President and his wife were forcibly taken away to the U.S. mainland by its special military squad, and the following month, the U.S. and Israeli military forces successfully carried out "decapitation (the removal of leadership by killing leaders)" airstrikes and killed nearly 50 senior Iranian political and military leaders with pinpoint accuracy. These outstanding results were both eventually achieved by incredibly advanced AI techs.

5 AI technology covers a wide range of fields that allow computers to simulate human learning, problem-solving and decision-making. Ukraine had to develop AI designed for drones from scratch, because no other country, including Western countries, assisted us.

6 We know that the leader of our enemy nation regards Ukraine as part of his territory, and most Japanese friends of mine tell me that they feel bitter about the situation where their country 3-1) [seem / still / to] be independent from the U.S. Some friends even argue that the U.S. has become the biggest threat since the end of World War II, again.

7 We all know that AI is the key ingredient for our future, and that every country competes desperately for developing better AI. In order to win this race, talented engineers' imaginative power and persistence, super computers for data processing, and a great deal of electricity and water for running and cooling computers are requirements, but fulfilling them all costs extremely massive financial resources: 3-2) [billions / more / than] dollars. Ironically, I know that in 2024, the private capital investment for AI in Japan was nearly one billion dollars, while astonishingly in the U.S., it was more than one 3-3) [greater / hundred / than] it was in Japan: $109 billion.

8 Ukraine and Japan boast a rich history of academic excellence and industrial innovations, and in the world today, both have no choice but to face up to serious threats from superpowers. Ukrainian and Japanese people may very well share their future through close technical cooperation. That's a blessing for both of us, and my speech is all about this. Thank you.

〈Questions〉

1. What is the meaning of numbered sentence 1)? Translate the sentence into Japanese, and write the translation on the ANSWER SHEET. In translation, don't forget to clarify what the pronouns "They" and "it" refer to. (4×1)

2. Select the most appropriate option from the list below to fill in each numbered blank space [1] and [2]. Write the matching letter, not the words, on the ANSWER SHEET. (3×2)

1) Paragraph 4 [1] paragraph 3.

a) demonstrates valid reasons for the correctness of
b) is the basic assumption of
c) obviously and literally conflicts with
(d) presents specific examples of the main content of

2) Paragraph 5 [2].

a) describes how Ukraine is capable of investing its fund in developing AI drones
(b) explains why Ukraine had to develop AI for drones for themselves from the beginning
c) implies that the AI technology Ukraine has developed is lacking in intellectual, technological property
d) proves that drones produced in Ukraine are the most efficient devices in the world's military history

3. Each numbered part 1) [ ] to 3) [ ] contains three words, but one word is missing to complete the phrase. Add the missing word to the original three and rearrange the four words in the correct order to complete the phrase. Write the whole Four words on the ANSWER SHEET. (2×3)

4. What is the gist (main idea) of the speaker Spokiy? Select the most appropriate option from the list below. Write the matching letter on the ANSWER SHEET. (3×1)

a) AI technology consists of so many different fields that Ukraine and Japan have great difficulty in improving it.

b) Almost all Ukrainians charge the Russian military authorities with threatening Ukrainian wildlife with extinction.

c) Between Ukraine and Japan, close interaction and shared achievements in technological development are expected.

d) Recognizing particular countries as common enemies will help bring people of Ukraine and Japan together.

e) The current advent of drones operated by AI has transformed the military balance between Ukraine and Russia.

f) Ukraine and Japan both need to spend more money on developing AI technology, as well as producing AI items.

g) Ukrainian success in developing and producing AI drones indicates that Japan requires investment more in technology development than in human resource education.